Daniel Milo

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Education

2022–2027 **New York University, Stern School of Business**
Ph.D. in Finance
Committee: Arpit Gupta (Chair), Alexi Savov, Sydney Ludvigson, Toomas Laarits

2016–2020 **Rutgers University, School of Arts and Sciences**
B.A. in Economics, Mathematics, and Computer Science, *Summa Cum Laude*

Research Interests

Asset Pricing, Monetary Economics, Real Estate

Working Papers

2026 **The Fed Attention Mechanism** (Job Market Paper)
Does Fed communication make the private sector better informed? I measure how markets divide their attention between Fed communications and other economic information using over 300,000 reports from professional macroeconomic forecasters. I develop a model in which Fed communications shape information processing costs and determine forecasters' allocation of attention. Supporting this framework, I find that Fed communications shift attention toward the Fed and the topics it emphasizes, crowding out independent economic research. As forecasters shift attention toward the Fed, they rely more on its communications to form their own economic expectations. Attention to the Fed improves the accuracy of short-rate forecasts but worsens forecasts of economic outcomes and longer-term rates. I next show that asset prices react to the magnitude of Fed communication surprises, measured across forecasters, particularly surprises about the Fed's economic outlook. These findings suggest that Fed communications make the private sector better informed about near-term interest rates, but less informed about the economy and longer-term rates.

2024 **The Costs of Housing Regulation: Evidence from Generative Regulatory Measurement**
With Alexander Bartik and Arpit Gupta
We introduce "generative regulatory measurement," using large language models to interpret administrative documents with 96% accuracy in binary classification and 0.87 correlation for continuous questions. Our analysis of U.S. zoning regulations reveals four facts: (1) housing regulations are multidimensional with two main principal components, (2) the first principal component represents value capture in high housing demand areas, (3) the second principal component associates with exclusionary zoning, increasing housing costs and socioeconomic exclusion, and (4) zoning follows a monocentric pattern with regional variations and is especially strict in Northeast suburbs. We develop a model of municipal regulatory choice consistent with these facts.

2025 **How Did Mortgage Market Segmentation Affect Early US Urban Development?**
How did historical financial markets shape urbanization? This paper studies the late 19th century, a time when the rate of urbanization peaked amid a large, highly heterogeneous, and mostly unintermediated mortgage market. I focus on the role of a new type of financial intermediary, the Building and Loan Association (B&L), in redirecting capital to urban development. Using newly digitized annual county-level mortgage data from 1880–1889 with nearly 30,000 observations and a complete history of B&L entry, I show suggestive evidence that the entry of the first B&L into a county reallocated capital from the rural to the urban mortgage market and accelerated real urbanization trends.

Work in Progress

2026 **The Origins of American Zoning**
With Alexander Bartik, Arpit Gupta, and Desmond O'Shaughnessy
We construct the first large-scale longitudinal dataset of American zoning ordinances using AI agents to direct archival requests. The resulting dataset spans nearly three thousand municipalities and over one hundred years. We document two key changes. First, codes have become substantially longer and more complex. Second, zoning has become more flexible while layering on additional procedural requirements and regulatory objectives. We next show that regulatory ideas diffuse across space: both regulatory concepts and specific clauses propagate between nearby municipalities. We rationalize these patterns through a framework in which municipalities pursue local policy objectives through costly adaptation of available regulatory ideas.

2026 **The Causal Effects of Zoning Regulations**
With Alexander Bartik, Arpit Gupta, and Luofeng Zhou
This paper estimates the causal effects of municipal zoning changes on housing markets. We construct a novel panel covering over 30 regulatory dimensions across more than 3,000 municipalities, using large language models to extract changes at scale from municipal zoning codes. We interpret the results through a spatial equilibrium model which generates three empirically distinguishable channels for supply, demand, and option value shifts. Combining synthetic difference-in-differences estimates of regulatory treatment effects with a calibrated model, we find that some regulations such as use liberalization operates through supply, while other regulations such as infill regulations like ADU legalization primarily operate through option value.

Selected Presentations

2026 NBER AI and Economic Measurement Conference
2025 Fordham Conference on Data Science and Law; Economic History Association; MIT Symposium on Technology, AI, and Real Estate; NYU Stern Finance Seminar
2024 Summer Institute Urban Economics and Real Estate*; North American Urban Economics Association; Council of Economic Advisors; NABE Tech; NYU Stern Finance Seminar
* Presentation by coauthor

Research Grants

Arnold Ventures for "Scaling Direct Municipal Outreach to Measure the Causal Effects of Zoning Reforms" (w/ Alexander Bartik, Arpit Gupta, Desmond O'Shaughnessy, and Luofeng Zhou)	$185,900
Coefficient Giving for "Understanding Housing Production: Causal Evidence and Public Data on Municipal Zoning" (w/ Alexander Bartik and Arpit Gupta)	$135,000
Campus Research Board for "The Historical Origins, Development, and Effects of Zoning Regulations: Evidence from the United States," 2026–27 (w/ Alexander Bartik and Arpit Gupta)	$29,472
Stern Center for Global Economy and Business Research Grant, 2025	$7,000
Henry Kaufman Initiative in Financial History, 2024	$7,110

Work Experience

Economist, Goldman Sachs — June 2020 – July 2022

Intern, Goldman Sachs — May 2019 – August 2019

Research Assistant, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia — May 2018 – May 2019

Teaching Experience

2025 Teaching Assistant, AI and Finance (Instructor: Prof. Arpit Gupta, Fall)
2025 Instructor, Foundations of Finance (Summer), Average Instructor Rating: 4.93/5
2025 Teaching Assistant, Foundations of Finance (Instructor: Prof. Toomas Laarits, Spring)

Academic Service

Referee: European Economic Review
Discussant: Urban Economics Association (2024); Fordham Conference on Data Science and Law (2025)
Session Chair: Urban Economics Association (2024)

Honors and Awards

2026–2027 Jules I. Bogen Fellowship, NYU Stern Finance
2020 John C. Daniel Award in Economics, Rutgers University
2020 Milton Friedman Scholar, Rutgers University
2020 High Honors in Economics; Honors in Mathematics, Rutgers University
2019 Cap & Skull Senior Honors Society Member
2018 Second Place, National Federal Reserve Challenge Competition